

How Helpful is ChatGPT for Developers?

If there is anything that has caught the attention of the tech world in the last few weeks, it is ChatGPT. The media is projecting it as the next big thing after Google Search Engine, and experts are competing with each other in predicting its impact on society. This article tries to peek into ChatGPT from the perspective of a software developer.



ChatGPT is a chatbot backed by artificial intelligence. Built by San Francisco-headquartered OpenAI, it was announced to the world in the month of November 2022.

In the words of ChatGPT, it is an AI assistant trained to help answer questions and provide information on a wide range of topics, including general knowledge, history, science, mathematics, language, and many others. Sounds familiar? Are search engines already not doing that job? There is a difference!

According to OpenAI, ChatGPT has been trained to interact in a conversational way. The dialogue format makes it possible for ChatGPT to answer follow-up questions, admit its mistakes, challenge incorrect premises, and reject inappropriate requests.

Using ChatGPT

Well, let's experience it! The first thing is to log in to ChatGPT. Visit the URL <https://chat.openai.com/auth/login> on any modern browser to open the login page. It appears as in Figure 1.

Since we haven't signed up yet, click on the 'Sign up' button. It opens the dialog, offering multiple ways to sign up.

In my case, I chose to continue with Google. After entering the Google credentials, it prompted for a name and phone number to initiate the verification process. Upon entering the received OTP, the ChatGPT opened up at the URL <https://chat.openai.com/chat>, as in Figure 2.

The ChatGPT clearly states that the current version is just a free research preview. Its goal is to get external feedback